

news feed

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hypothesis

CME

■ What is CME?

Core Management System (CME) is being developed by American BIOS manufacturer Phoenix. It aims to supplement their new BIOS versions, and work hand in hand with Windows to make computing more secure, using Core System Software.

■ How does it work?

It works with Windows Longhorn, which blends software and hardware-based Digital Rights Management via the Next Generation Secure Computing Base (NGSCB). Additionally, Device-Net-worked Architecture (d-NA) is exposed to the developers to better utilise the resources of the new system.

■ What does it do?

CME has a cryptographic engine and a service provider at the hardware level, thus providing a tamper-proof location for secure services and secure applications to function. Functions such as seeking an authorised hardware device to transfer a file should be relatively reliable.

Segway to become battlefield bot

Researchers are working to modify the Segway Human Transporter into a battlefield robot, which can be used for transporting injured soldiers to safety, or for following soldiers while carrying equipment for them. The modified transporters will be good alternatives to the four-wheeled robotic vehicles currently in use, because they

have a high centre of gravity, allowing cameras and sensors to be placed several feet above the ground. DARPA has invested \$26 million on this project, in the last year alone. At the Carnegie-Mellon University, Segway robots have been developed that can move and kick soccer balls. Researchers at the University of Southern California are working on a Seg-

way Robot that can follow humans and carry up to 50 kg of gear for them.

When Transporters were launched in 2001, Segway was expecting sales in millions. So far, however, they have only been in the thousands. Segway is therefore welcoming this initiative, as it would help increase sales and lower prices.

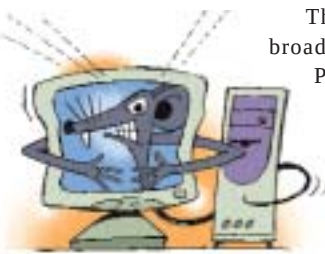
A RAT in your PC

According to a recent report by Sophos, an anti-virus and anti-spam company, almost 30 per cent of spam being circulated is relayed by PCs infected with Remote Access Trojans (RATs). A RAT is a Trojan horse that gives full control of the PC to the attacker,

allowing him or her to send e-mails with that user's name. Further, the attackers remove all traces of their activities from the PCs.

The main targets are broadband users whose PCs aren't secured properly.

The report also states that the purpose of making viruses is changing from creating chaos to getting financial rewards.



ILLUSTRATOR: Mahesh Benkar

Reprintable paper

The paperless office may be a long way away, but Toshiba has developed an ink that can be used with ball pens or laser printers, and can be erased by passing through an erasing machine, that can erase 200 pages in two hours. The ink is made up of three different chemicals—two mix to give the ink its colour, while the third reverses the process at

the time of erasing, causing the ink to become invisible. It owes its name—E-blue—to its colour.

According to Toshiba, paper makes up 40 per cent of the office waste in Japan. E-blue will help cut office waste and recycle paper. The entire setup, including the toner and the erasing machine, is priced at ¥300,00 (around Rs 1,26,000).

A Linux-based Tablet PC

A company called Element Computers (www.elementcomputer.com) has just launched the world's first sub-\$1000 tablet PC, named Helium 2100. The PC runs the Desktop/LX Tablet Edition OS from Lycoris. It has a VIA 1GHz Antaur processor, a 30 GB hard drive, 256 MB of RAM, and a 14.1-inch XGA screen. The PC features basic touch-screen functions, but handwriting recognition is still under development; it may be released next year as a software upgrade.

According to Element, the low cost of this tablet PC has been made possible because Windows is not pre-installed, thanks to its 'No Windows' policy, and offers laptops with the Desktop/LX operating system for as low as \$799 (around Rs 35,955). Element also offers pre-tested hardware through its online store.

snapshot

168 million PC units expected to ship in 2004, translating to a **14 per cent** growth of the market

Source: Gartner